the Tibetan Buddhists.[73] The Manmohan Singh government offered a financial package for the return and rehabilitation of Kashmiri Pandits in 2008, but the amount per family was too low to evoke serious interest. The saga of the Kashmiri exodus remains an unresolved matter with vacant properties in Kashmir and migrant camps in Jammu.

The Kashmiri exodus is whipped up routinely by Hindu fundamentalists in 21st century India to show how Muslims can dominate Hindus within 'their' own country. The real lesson of the episode, however, is to note the toxic cocktail of hyper-religiosity, hyper-nationalism and hyper-masculinity that marked the events of 1989–90. It is a heady cocktail that unfortunately continues to re-surface every now and then, both in India and the world.

## Internal Displacement

The multiple partitions of the Indian subcontinent and various refugee crises led to significant displacements across political borders. And yet, it was internal displacement within India, like the Kashmiri exodus, that was of far greater magnitude and reach. Natural disasters, floods and storms pushed hundreds of thousands of people out of their comfort zones for brief periods every year. The history of communal riots in India provides a painful litany of displacements towards shelter camps and slums, most infamously in Delhi and Punjab during the Hindu-Sikh conflict in the 1980s and in Gujarat during the Hindu-Muslim riots over several decades, especially in 2002. More generally, war and famine, two major sources of internal displacement in India throughout history, waned in significance over the 20th century. They were replaced by ethnic conflict and development projects as the key factors stimulating involuntary movement. What was common to both was the disproportionate and adverse impact on the indigenous population, or the STs.

The unique demography of India's north-eastern region and the special political status conferred on it via the Sixth Schedule of the Indian Constitution precipitated several inter-tribal and tribal-migrant conflicts.[74] What began as one or two demands for separate homelands and